Annual Business Report

Desert Sun Consulting

100 pts

Unit 2 — Word Processing · Core Project Option A

/ 100 points

How to use this instruction sheet: Download the starter file from the Project Grader, open it in Microsoft Word 365, and keep this sheet open beside it. Work through each task in order. Each task tells you what to do, why it matters, and where to find the tool — but you must figure out the exact steps yourself. That's the learning.

Screen Recording Requirement

To verify your own work, record yourself completing 3 tasks while working on this project.

- Use Xbox Game Bar (press Win+G) or Loom (loom.com — free account) to record your screen
- Show yourself completing any 3 tasks from the list below
- Submit the recording to Canvas along with your completed file

D1 — Manage Documents

22 points (10 tasks)

2

Task 1 — Set 1-inch margins on all sides

WHY THIS MATTERS

Professional documents use consistent margins so text doesn't crowd the edges. 1-inch margins are the standard for business reports.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Layout tab → Page Setup group → Margins → Custom Margins. Enter 1" for Top, Bottom, Left, and Right.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The white space around your text looks even on all four sides. The ruler at the top shows the margin boundary at the 1-inch mark.

2

Task 2 — Set page orientation to Portrait

WHY THIS MATTERS

Portrait orientation (taller than wide) is standard for business reports. The Financial Summary section uses Landscape — that's a separate task.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Layout tab → Page Setup group → Orientation → Portrait.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Your pages are taller than they are wide (standard 8.5" × 11" orientation).

2

Task 3 — Apply the "Basic (Stylish)" style set to the entire document

WHY THIS MATTERS

Style sets change the fonts and colors of all built-in styles (Title, Heading 1, etc.) at once, giving the document a consistent professional look.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Document Formatting group → the Style Sets gallery (the row of "Aa" thumbnails). Hover over each to preview.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The document's heading fonts and colors change to match the Basic (Stylish) theme. The name "Basic (Stylish)" appears when you hover.

3

Task 4 — Insert a header with the company name left-aligned and today's date right-aligned

WHY THIS MATTERS

Headers appear on every page and help readers identify the document and track when it was created.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Header & Footer group → Header → Edit Header. Type the company name, then press Tab twice to move to the right, then insert the date using Insert → Date & Time.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every page shows the company name on the left side of the header and the date on the right side.

2

Task 5 — Insert a footer with "Confidential" centered

WHY THIS MATTERS

A confidentiality notice in the footer protects sensitive business information and appears on every printed page.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Header & Footer group → Footer → Edit Footer. Press Tab once to move to the center, then type "Confidential".

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every page shows "Confidential" centered in the footer area.

2

Task 6 — Insert page numbers in the bottom-right corner of the footer

WHY THIS MATTERS

Page numbers help readers navigate a multi-page document and are required for professional business reports.

WHERE TO FIND IT

While in the footer, go to Header & Footer tab → Header & Footer group → Page Number → Bottom of Page → choose a right-aligned option.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each page shows its correct page number in the bottom-right corner.

2

Task 7 — Add a "DRAFT" watermark to all pages

WHY THIS MATTERS

A watermark visually communicates that the document is not the final version, preventing premature distribution.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Page Background group → Watermark → choose DRAFT 1 from the gallery, or click Custom Watermark to type your own.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The word "DRAFT" appears diagonally in light gray text behind the content on every page.

2

Task 8 — Set document properties: Title = "Annual Business Report 2026", Author = "Desert Sun Consulting"

WHY THIS MATTERS

Document properties embed metadata that helps identify files in shared folders and appears in search results.

WHERE TO FIND IT

File tab → Info → look for the Properties panel on the RIGHT side of the screen. Click the Title field and type the title.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

File → Info shows the correct Title and Author in the Properties panel on the right.

2

Task 9 — Run the Accessibility Checker and note any issues in a comment

WHY THIS MATTERS

Accessibility checking identifies content that screen readers cannot interpret, which is required for compliance with disability access laws.

WHERE TO FIND IT

File tab → Info → Check for Issues → Check Accessibility. A pane opens listing any errors. Add a comment in the document noting what you found.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The Accessibility Check pane has opened, and you've added a comment somewhere in the document noting the results.

3

Task 10 — Save a copy of the document as a PDF file

WHY THIS MATTERS

PDF format preserves your exact formatting on any device or printer, making it ideal for sharing the final report.

WHERE TO FIND IT

File tab → Save As → choose a location → click the "Save as type" dropdown → select PDF (*.pdf) → Save.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A PDF file appears in the same folder as your Word document. The filename should end in .pdf.

D2 — Format Text & Paragraphs

20 points (8 tasks)

2

Task 11 — Use Find & Replace to change every instance of "DSC" to "Desert Sun Consulting"

WHY THIS MATTERS

The starter file uses the abbreviation "DSC" throughout. A professional report should use the full company name. Find & Replace does this in seconds rather than hunting manually.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Home tab → Editing group → Replace (or press Ctrl+H). Type "DSC" in Find What and "Desert Sun Consulting" in Replace With. Click Replace All.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A message tells you how many replacements were made. Search for "DSC" again — it should not be found anywhere.

2

Task 12 — Apply the Title style to the document's main title on the cover page

WHY THIS MATTERS

The Title style is a special built-in style that formats the document's main heading and can be referenced by the Table of Contents.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click on the main title text on the cover page. Then go to Home tab → Styles group → click "Title" in the styles gallery.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The cover page title text changes to a large, distinctive font that looks different from the body text.

3

Task 13 — Apply Heading 1 style to every major section header in the document

WHY THIS MATTERS

Heading 1 creates the top-level structure of your document. It tells Word which text is a section title, which is required for the Table of Contents to work automatically.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click on a section header, then Home tab → Styles group → "Heading 1". Repeat for every section header. You can also use the Format Painter to apply it faster.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

All section headers now appear in a consistent larger, colored font. The Navigation Pane (View → Navigation Pane) shows them as top-level items.

3

Task 14 — Apply Heading 2 style to every subsection header in the document

WHY THIS MATTERS

Heading 2 creates the second level of your document hierarchy, appearing indented under Heading 1 items in the Table of Contents.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click on a subsection header → Home tab → Styles group → "Heading 2". Repeat for all subsection headers.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Subsection headers appear in a slightly smaller, distinct format from Heading 1. They appear indented in the Navigation Pane.

2

Task 15 — Set body text line spacing to 1.15 throughout the document

WHY THIS MATTERS

1.15 line spacing improves readability by adding a small gap between lines without taking up as much space as double spacing.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select all body text (Ctrl+A to select all), then Home tab → Paragraph group → Line and Paragraph Spacing button (the icon with lines and arrows) → 1.15.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Body text lines have a small but noticeable gap between them. The Paragraph dialog (Layout tab) shows 1.15 in the Line spacing field.

2

Task 16 — Set 6pt spacing after each paragraph

WHY THIS MATTERS

Spacing after paragraphs creates visual separation between ideas without requiring extra blank lines, which is the professional standard.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select all text (Ctrl+A) → Layout tab → Paragraph group → change "After" to 6 pt. Or use Home tab → Line Spacing → Line Spacing Options → Spacing After.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

There is a visible gap after each paragraph when you press Enter. The Layout tab → Paragraph group shows "6 pt" in the After field.

3

Task 17 — Use Format Painter to copy the Executive Summary paragraph formatting to the Conclusion paragraph

WHY THIS MATTERS

Format Painter copies all formatting (font, size, spacing, color) from one place and applies it to another instantly — much faster than reformatting manually.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click anywhere in the Executive Summary paragraph. Go to Home tab → Clipboard group → click the Format Painter brush. Your cursor becomes a paintbrush. Then click and drag over the Conclusion paragraph text.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The Conclusion paragraph now has the exact same font, size, and spacing as the Executive Summary paragraph.

3

Task 18 — Insert a section break before the Financial Summary section and change that section's orientation to Landscape

WHY THIS MATTERS

A section break lets you apply different page settings to one part of a document. The Financial Summary table is wide and needs Landscape to fit properly.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Place your cursor just before the Financial Summary heading. Layout tab → Page Setup group → Breaks → Next Page (under Section Breaks). Then click anywhere in that section → Layout tab → Orientation → Landscape.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The Financial Summary section appears on a Landscape page while the rest of the document remains Portrait.

D3 — Tables & Lists

14 points (6 tasks)

3

Task 19 — Create a 4-column table for the quarterly revenue data

WHY THIS MATTERS

Tables organize data into rows and columns, making financial figures much easier to read and compare than plain paragraph text.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Position your cursor where the table should go. Insert tab → Tables group → Table → drag to select a 4-column grid. Or click Insert Table and specify 4 columns.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A table with 4 columns appears in your document. You can click in any cell and type.

2

Task 20 — Merge the top row cells to create a single title spanning all 4 columns

WHY THIS MATTERS

Merging the header row cells lets you add a centered title like "Quarterly Revenue Summary" that spans the entire table width.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select all cells in row 1 by clicking the first cell and dragging to the last. Then Layout tab (Table Layout) → Merge group → Merge Cells.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Row 1 is now one wide cell instead of four separate cells. You can type a title that spans the full width.

2

Task 21 — Sort the client table alphabetically by the Client Name column

WHY THIS MATTERS

Alphabetical sorting makes tables easier to scan, especially for long lists where readers need to find a specific client quickly.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click anywhere in the client table. Layout tab (Table Layout) → Data group → Sort. Select the Client Name column, choose Text, Ascending. Click OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The rows in your client table are now in alphabetical order (A to Z) by client name.

2

Task 22 — Create a numbered list of the 5 strategic objectives

WHY THIS MATTERS

Numbered lists show sequence or ranking, making ordered information easier to follow than plain paragraphs.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Type each objective on its own line. Select all 5 lines. Home tab → Paragraph group → Numbering button (the icon with 1. 2. 3. and lines).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each objective is automatically numbered 1 through 5. Adding or deleting items updates the numbers automatically.

2

Task 23 — Create a bulleted list of services offered with sub-items under each service

WHY THIS MATTERS

Bulleted lists organize non-sequential items visually. Sub-items show which services belong under each main category.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Type each service and sub-service. Select the items. Home tab → Paragraph group → Bullets button. For sub-items, place your cursor at the start of the line and press Tab to indent.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Main services have a bullet (•) and sub-services are indented with a different bullet style.

3

Task 24 — Increase the list level for all sub-items under each service

WHY THIS MATTERS

Increasing the list level (indenting) creates a visual hierarchy that shows which items are subordinate to which main item.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click at the beginning of a sub-item line (or select multiple sub-items). Home tab → Paragraph group → Increase Indent button. Or press Tab while the cursor is at the start of the line.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Sub-items are indented further to the right than the main items and may have a different bullet symbol.

D4 — References

10 points (3 tasks)

3

Task 25 — Insert an automatic Table of Contents after the title page

WHY THIS MATTERS

An automatic TOC uses your Heading styles to build a clickable list of sections with page numbers — it updates automatically when you add or move content.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Position your cursor on a blank page after the cover page. References tab → Table of Contents group → Table of Contents → choose one of the Automatic styles.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A Table of Contents appears listing all your Heading 1 and Heading 2 sections with page numbers.

3

Task 26 — Customize the Table of Contents to show only Heading 1 and Heading 2 levels

WHY THIS MATTERS

Showing only 2 heading levels keeps the TOC concise. A 3-level TOC can become cluttered in a business report.

WHERE TO FIND IT

References tab → Table of Contents → Custom Table of Contents → change "Show levels" to 2 → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The TOC shows only your Heading 1 and Heading 2 items, not any Heading 3 items.

4

Task 27 — Insert a footnote on the revenue figure that cites the data source

WHY THIS MATTERS

Footnotes give credit to data sources and add credibility to financial figures without cluttering the main text.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Place your cursor immediately after the revenue figure (e.g., after "$4.2 million"). References tab → Footnotes group → Insert Footnote. A footnote number appears and your cursor jumps to the bottom of the page where you type the citation.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A superscript number appears after the revenue figure, and the matching footnote text appears at the bottom of that page.

D5 — Graphic Elements

20 points (7 tasks)

3

Task 28 — Insert the DSC logo image and position it in the top-right corner of the cover page

WHY THIS MATTERS

A company logo on the cover page establishes brand identity and gives the report a professional, polished appearance.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Illustrations group → Pictures → This Device (insert the logo file). Then use the Position option under Picture Format → Arrange → Position to place it top-right.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The logo appears in the top-right area of the cover page. Text does not run behind or over the logo.

2

Task 29 — Apply the "Drop Shadow Rectangle" picture style to the logo

WHY THIS MATTERS

Picture styles add borders, shadows, and effects that make images look more polished and integrated into the document design.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click the logo to select it. Picture Format tab → Picture Styles group → look through the gallery for "Drop Shadow Rectangle" (hover over each to see the name).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The logo has a visible drop shadow behind it, giving it a slight 3D lifted appearance.

2

Task 30 — Set text wrapping to "Through" for the logo

WHY THIS MATTERS

Text wrapping controls how surrounding text flows around an image. "Through" allows text to wrap around the actual shape of the image, not just its bounding box.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click the logo. Picture Format tab → Arrange group → Wrap Text → Through. Or right-click the image → Wrap Text → Through.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Text flows around the logo's shape rather than leaving a rectangular empty space.

3

Task 31 — Insert a SmartArt Hierarchy diagram for the organizational chart

WHY THIS MATTERS

SmartArt graphics convert plain text into professional diagrams. A Hierarchy diagram visually shows reporting relationships much more clearly than a list.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Illustrations group → SmartArt → Hierarchy category → choose a hierarchy layout → OK. Type department names in the text pane on the left.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A hierarchy diagram appears showing boxes connected by lines, representing the organizational structure.

3

Task 32 — Modify the SmartArt content to show the actual DSC department names

WHY THIS MATTERS

The SmartArt needs to reflect real organizational data, not placeholder text, for the report to be accurate and useful.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click on the SmartArt to select it. Click the arrow on the left edge to open the Text pane. Click in each box and type the department name. Or click directly on each shape in the diagram.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each box in the hierarchy shows a real department name from the Desert Sun Consulting org chart.

3

Task 33 — Insert a text box on the cover page with the report tagline

WHY THIS MATTERS

Text boxes let you place text anywhere on the page independently of the normal text flow, which is useful for design elements like taglines and callouts.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Text group → Text Box → Draw Text Box. Click and drag to draw the box on the cover page. Then type the tagline inside it.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A text box containing the tagline appears on the cover page. You can drag it independently of the other text.

4

Task 34 — Add descriptive alt text to EVERY image and SmartArt in the document

WHY THIS MATTERS

Alt text describes images to screen reader users who cannot see visual content. It is required for ADA compliance and accessibility standards.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Right-click each image or SmartArt → Edit Alt Text. Type a clear description of what the image shows. Do this for every image in the document.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Right-clicking any image shows "Edit Alt Text" and the pane shows your description text.

D6 — Collaboration

14 points (6 tasks)

2

Task 35 — Add a comment on the revenue figure requesting verification

WHY THIS MATTERS

Comments allow collaborators to ask questions or flag items without changing the document content. They appear in a sidebar and can be replied to.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the revenue figure text. Review tab → Comments group → New Comment. Type your verification request in the comment bubble that appears.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A comment bubble appears in the right margin connected to the revenue figure text.

2

Task 36 — Reply to the existing manager comment already in the document

WHY THIS MATTERS

Replying to comments creates a conversation thread, which is how teams collaborate on documents in professional settings.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click on the existing manager comment in the sidebar. Click the Reply button that appears below the comment text. Type your reply.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Your reply appears indented below the original manager comment, creating a conversation thread.

2

Task 37 — Resolve the comment after the verification is complete

WHY THIS MATTERS

Resolving comments marks them as addressed without deleting them, so there's a record that the issue was handled.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click the comment you want to resolve. Click the three-dot menu (...) in the comment → Resolve Thread. Or right-click the comment → Resolve Comment.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The comment appears grayed out or marked as resolved and is no longer highlighted in the document.

3

Task 38 — Enable Track Changes and make 3 edits to the Executive Summary

WHY THIS MATTERS

Track Changes records every edit you make — who made it and when — so collaborators can review, accept, or reject each change individually.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Review tab → Tracking group → Track Changes → Track Changes (click to toggle on). It should appear highlighted/active. Then make 3 edits to the Executive Summary text.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Your edits appear in a different color with underline (insertions) or strikethrough (deletions). The Review tab shows Track Changes is active.

2

Task 39 — Accept all tracked changes from the manager

WHY THIS MATTERS

Accepting changes incorporates them permanently into the document, removing the tracked markup and finalizing the content.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Review tab → Changes group → Accept dropdown → Accept All Changes. This accepts every tracked change in the document at once.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

All tracked change markup disappears. The text looks clean with no colored additions or strikethroughs.

3

Task 40 — Reject the one tracked change that removed important data

WHY THIS MATTERS

Rejecting a change undoes that specific edit and restores the original text, while keeping other accepted changes intact.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Review tab → Changes group → use Next/Previous to navigate to the tracked change that removed data. Click Reject (not Reject All) to reject only that one change.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The rejected change is restored — the deleted text reappears in the document. Other changes remain accepted.